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Healey aims to contain soaring utility costs

But even supporters say plan is thin on details

By Sabrina Shankman
and Samantha J. Gross

GLOBE STAFF

It's springtime in Boston, so the heat is off and the air conditioning isn't yet fired up. But lest anyone forget, the cost of energy in Massachusetts hit sky-high levels this winter, with households spending more of their paychecks on electricity and heating than most places in the country.

In an effort to tackle those costs, Governor Maura Healey proposed multiple changes and new initiatives for how energy is bought, financed, and billed in Massachusetts, measures that she said would save ratepayers some \$10 billion over the next decade.

Among the proposals: removing or drastically reducing charges now on utility bills, such as fees to subsidize energy efficiency programs, so that consumers are only charged for the costs of delivering energy to their homes, increasing accountability of utilities, and making it easier to add cutting-edge nuclear energy technologies to the grid.

"This legislation is going to give us tools that we need to create more accountability for our utilities and maximize every single rate payer dollar," Healey said at an event in Leominster announcing the proposed bill.

The governor, however, did not provide a detailed analysis of how each measure would add up to \$10 billion in savings.

ENERGY, Page A5

Israeli officials warn of Gaza starvation

Counters long-held stance on aid blockade

By Natan Odenheimer
and Ronen Bergman

NEW YORK TIMES

Some Israeli military officials have privately concluded that Palestinians in the Gaza Strip face widespread starvation unless aid deliveries are restored within weeks, according to three Israeli defense officials familiar with conditions in the enclave.

For months, Israel has maintained that its blockade on food and fuel to Gaza did not pose a major threat to civilian life in the territory, even as the United Nations and other aid agencies have said a famine was looming.

But Israeli military officers who monitor humanitarian conditions in Gaza have warned their commanders in recent days that unless the blockade is lifted quickly, many areas of the enclave will likely run out of enough food to meet minimum daily nutritional needs, according to the defense officials. They spoke on the condition of anonymity to share sensitive details.

Because it takes time to scale up humanitarian deliveries, the officers said that immediate steps were needed to ensure that the system to supply aid could be reinstated fast enough to prevent starvation.

The growing acknowledgment within part of the Israeli security establishment of a hun-

MIDEAST, Page A4

Harvard's funding cuts near \$3b

Multiple agencies join Trump's fight; 'this is no longer a speculative problem'

By Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

President Trump's campaign against Harvard shows no signs of abating as the number of agencies cutting off grants to the school has grown to at least nine, with the total amount of slashed funding approaching \$3 billion.

Those revelations emerged in an updated lawsuit from Harvard

against the Trump administration filed Tuesday, hours after the government's antisemitism task force announced another \$450 million in grants were recently terminated.

The breadth of the pressure campaign, which now involves agencies ranging from Agriculture to Defense, underscores what some supporters have called the White House's "whole of government approach" to

reshaping Harvard to align with Trump's worldview and agenda.

In its lawsuit, originally filed on April 21, Harvard alleges the government's tactics are illegal and violate the Constitution. But so far it has not received any interim relief from the court while the Trump campaign escalates day by day.

The university now faces a dizzying array of threats.

The National Institutes of Health, the biggest funder of scientific research in the country, has terminated \$2.2 billion of grants and con-

tracts for Harvard researchers. Multiple agencies, including the Department of Education and the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission, have launched investigations into alleged discrimination by Harvard against white people, Asian Americans, men, and heterosexuals. There are inquiries into Harvard's sources of foreign funding and its internal fact-finding on campus antisemitism.

Trump has pushed to revoke the university's tax-exempt status and

HARVARD, Page A6



PHOTOS BY SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Lisa Boyce, wife of the late Kevin Boyce, looked over photos in her mother-in-law's Sudbury home. Kevin Boyce died after contracting Powassan virus, a tick-borne illness. Below, a photo of Kevin Boyce with his granddaughter, Addison.

PUZZLING, FATAL ILLNESS STARTED WITH TICK BITE

Climate change means more insects — and more cases of dangerous virus

By Erin Douglas
GLOBE STAFF

SUDBURY — Lisa Boyce, 56, gave the dog a few pats, grabbed her husband's hand, and hit play on her phone.

Soon, the Allman Brothers' "Melissa" filled the hospice care room. Her husband would've liked this stillness, she thought. Just the two of them, their dog, Chubbs, and pink cherry blossoms swaying outside the window. Kevin Boyce was a homebody at heart.

It was hard to believe he was dying. Just weeks prior, he was peeling off his heavy boots as he got home from work. He was sinking into the couch to watch TV with her. He was romping around on the living room floor with his now 2-year-old granddaughter.

Her mind raced through the last two-and-a-half weeks of tests, procedures, and frantic phone calls. All of this suffering from a tiny tick bite?

Kevin Boyce, 62, died on May 8, 2024. His death is a painful and extreme example of the

'There's no magic pill. There really isn't anything other than supportive care.'

STEPHEN RICH, *microbiology professor at UMass Amherst, speaking about the Powassan virus*



cost of rising tick-borne disease in New England, where black-legged deer ticks are endemic. To blame are rising temperatures from climate change, which allow more ticks to survive milder winters. A proliferating population of white-tailed deer, one of the ticks' favored hosts, doesn't help.

Lyme disease cases in the US have more than tripled over the last three decades, and those figures only capture a fraction of the true total, since many cases go unreported. It's a similar story for other tick-borne illnesses: Anaplasmosis, Babesiosis, and Powassan virus — a particularly deadly disease — are all on the rise.

Almost four times the number of people are sickened by the very rare but very dangerous Powassan virus now compared to a decade ago, according to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention.

"It's still a rare disease, but it is worrisome because the numbers are increasing in Massa-

TICKS, Page A7

Tatum undergoes surgery on ruptured Achilles' tendon



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Jayson Tatum's injury late in the fourth quarter Monday night proved to be as bad as it appeared.

Injury puts championship run — and future — in question for Celtics

By Adam Himmelsbach
GLOBE STAFF

Amid the anguish of Jayson Tatum's leg injury Monday night, Celtics faithful clung to at least a glimmer of hope. Maybe it wasn't as bad as it looked. Maybe the NBA's most durable superstar had avoided the worst.

Internally, though, it quickly became clear that the prognosis was grim. The tears of team staffers in the bowels of Madison Square Garden were evidence of that.

Tatum suffered a ruptured right Achilles' tendon in the final

minutes of Boston's loss in Game 4 of the Eastern Conference semifinals and underwent successful surgery on Tuesday morning to repair it, according to the Celtics.

According to a league source, the injury was confirmed when Tatum underwent testing Tuesday morning and the decision was made to operate immediately because swift action following Achilles' injuries tends to lead to more favorable outcomes.

The source added that complications during these proce-

TATUM, Page C2

US inflation cooled slightly in April in what economists warn could be a lull before a likely surge in prices. **B5**

More than 200 people protested in Worcester against the Trump administration's immigrant deportations. **B1.**



Mow town

Wednesday: Cloudy, breezy. High: 60-65. Low: 53-58.

Thursday: Cloudy, showers. High: 61-66. Low: 56-61.

Comics and Weather, **G6-7.** Obituaries, **C9.**

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Rose, Jackson back in MLB

Commissioner Rob Manfred's decision makes them eligible for the Hall of Fame after their careers were tarnished by gambling scandals. **C1.**